ONE Clinical Seating and Positioning Protocol

POSSIBLE F-TAG/QMS

FEDERAL TAGS (F-TAGS)

- F684: Quality of care, which includes not providing care or services that a resident has declined
- F686: Treatment or services to prevent or heal pressure ulcers
- F688-Increase/ Prevent decrease in ROM/Mobility
- F689: Free of accident hazards, supervision, and devices
- F697- Pain Management

Quality Measures

- New/Worsened Pressure Ulcers
- Moderate/Severe Pain
- Falls with major injury

THERAPIES

- PT
- OT
- SLP

PURPOSE OF THERAPY

- Engage in functional activities
- Promote resident comfort and relaxation
- Maintain proper skeletal alignment and head and neck positioning
- Proper alignment for swallowing, digestion, and self-feeding
- Promote proper respiratory support and speech production
- Manage or prevent development of pressure areas
- Reduce fatigue and manage tone
- Reduce musculoskeletal related pain and promote proper LE circulation
- Promote and/or maintain mobility and independence throughout facility/ community
- Promote psychosocial well-being/reducing isolation through facility engagement

GOAL EXAMPLES

PT Goals:

- Pt will maintain upright neutral position in wheelchair for 2 hours with no redness or s/sx of skin breakdown on coccyx and ischial tuberosities.
- Pt will be able to remain in wheelchair for activities of leisure for 4 hours with no c/o musculoskeletal pain 0/10.
- The patient will demonstrate the ability to reposition the wheelchair (e.g., turning toward activities or people) to facilitate engagement during social interactions or therapy sessions, achieving this 8/10 times.
- The patient will propel wheelchair X 50 feet using Bilateral UE extremities while maintaining proper upright midline positioning.

OT Goals:

- Patient will be independent with wheelchair pressure relief 3/5 attempts with min verbal prompts.
- Patient will independently request wheelchair pressure relief from care staff q 2 hours using established visual reminders.

TOOLS, ASSESSMENTS AND IMPLEMENTATION

Tools and Assessment

Seating and Positioning Assessment include:

- Neuromuscular status
- Orthopedic factors
- Functional status
- Cognition and behavior
- Visual perceptual skills
- Environment
- Locomotion

Postural Assessment:

- Pelvic Position: Check for neutral pelvic alignment to prevent pressure sores and discomfort.
- Spinal Alignment: Ensure the spine maintains its natural curves to avoid back pain and deformities.
- Lower Extremity Positioning: Feet should rest flat on footrests with knees at a 90-degree angle to promote circulation and prevent contractures.

Pressure Distribution:

- Use specialized cushions and backrests to distribute pressure evenly and prevent pressure ulcers.
- Regularly monitor skin integrity, especially in high-pressure areas like the sacrum and heels.

Measurement Guide:

- Seat Depth: Measure from the back of the buttocks to the back of the knees to ensure proper support without pressure on the thighs.

#ONE Clinical Wheelchair Seating and Positioning Protocol

POSSIBLE F-TAG/QMS	THERAPIES	PURPOSE OF THERAPY	GOAL EXAMPLES	TOOLS & ASSESSMENTS
		Staff training and education to ensure carryover of proper positioning to minimize fall risk	Patient will maintain proper wheelchair positioning to enhance safety during mealtime, with successful self-feeding for at least 5 consecutive meals. The patient will maintain optimal seating posture in their wheelchair in order to independently use adaptive utensils during mealtime, demonstrating the ability to eat without assistance for at least two meals per day. The patient will adjust their seating position to facilitate dressing tasks, requiring CGA to dress their upper body during morning routine. The patient will utilize appropriate positioning techniques in their wheelchair to complete personal hygiene tasks (e.g., brushing teeth, washing hands, with no LOB independently. Patient will be able to maneuver wheelchair in and around small spaces to complete ADL's and toileting tasks with minimal verbal cues. **SLP Goals:** The patient will maintain a stable and appropriate sitting posture in the wheelchair while engaging in conversation for 10 minutes with 80% accuracy. The patient will demonstrate improved breath support during speech activities while seated in the wheelchair, achieving consistent phrasing for 3 sentences.	Seat Width: Measure the widest part of the hips and add a couple of inches for comfort. Seat Height: Measure from the floor to the crease behind the knee to set the seat height correctly. Backrest Height: Measure from the seat surface to the top of the shoulder blades for adequate upper body support. Footrest Height: Measure from the floor to the bottom of the heel to prevent feet from dangling or pressing too hard. Armrest Height: Measure from the seat surface to the elbow to ensure forearms rest comfortably without straining the shoulders. **Wheelchair Skills Test (WST):** This test evaluates the patient's ability to perform various wheelchair skills safely and effectively. **Power-Mobility Indoor Driving Assessment (PIDA):** This assessment measures the patient's ability to navigate indoor environments safely using a power wheelchair. **Safety Assessment:** Maintenance: Regularly check the wheelchair for any wear and tear, including tires, brakes, and upholstery. Anti-Tip Devices: Check that anti-tip devices are installed and functioning properly. **Implementation:** Quarterly Assessments: PT and OT regularly assess and adjust the wheelchair to ensure it meets the patient's needs. • Cushion Selection: Options include offloading, immersion, and envelopment cushions. • Back Support • Footrests and Leg Supports Education and Training: Ensure caregivers and patients are educated on proper positioning techniques and adjustments.

POSSIBLE F-TAG/QMS	THERAPIES	PURPOSE OF THERAPY	GOAL EXAMPLES	TOOLS & ASSESSMENTS
			The patient will maintain appropriate posture in the wheelchair during mealtimes to promote safe swallowing and oral motor control, achieving this in 100% of meal sessions. The patient will participate in oral motor exercises while positioned in the wheelchair, achieving proper head and neck alignment, for 3 sessions per week, with improved strength and coordination observed.	